Cristiano Cordì

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EXPERIENCES AND PROJECTS

Research Intern (Master Thesis) @ VIB.AI [Sep 2024 - Aug 2025]

"Deciphering organism-wide gene regulation with genomic deep learning in C. elegans."

Developed deep learning models (convolutional and attention-based) to predict single-cell gene expression directly from genomic sequence in C. elegans. Integrated developmental-stage datasets and applied explainable AI methods to uncover regulatory features, advancing understanding of genome-wide regulatory logic.

TRIDENT (Tri-Dimensional Embeddings Navigation Tool) [Aug 2025 - Ongoing]

Developed TRIDENT, a Blender add-on made with Python and C++ that makes 3D visualization of embeddings from UMAPs and t-SNE dimesionality reduction plots intuitive and fast.

OpenNano – NanoString GeoMx Data Processing Toolkit. [Oct 2024 - Jan 2025]

Developed OpenNano, a toolkit aimed at streamlining the processing and analysis of NanoString GeoMx data using Python.

Bachelor's Degree Thesis [Jun 2022 - Dec 2022]

"The expression of CCRL2 combined to specialized endothelial cell signature is prognostic in human lung cancers."

Analyzed RNA-seq expression data from tumor patients taken from the TCGA database to understand the role of the atypical receptor CCRL2 in the endothelial population of cells in the lungs, in relation to natural killer cells and neutrophils.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Master of Bioinformatics (MSc) [Oct 2023 - Feb 2026]

KU Leuven ***https://www.kuleuven.be/kuleuven/***
Field of study: Bioscience Engineering
Graduated ***Cum laude***

Bachelor of Bioinformatics (BSc) [Oct 2019 - Mar 2023]

La Sapienza University of Rome ***https://www.uniroma1.it/***
Fields of study: Natural sciences, mathematics and statistics, *Inter-disciplinary programmes and qualifications involving natural sciences, mathematics and statistics*

COMPETENCES

Programming Languages: Python, R, Java, Bash, C++
High-Performance Computing (HPC): Experience with HPCs (Vlaams Supercomputer Centrum)
Deep Learning: CNNs, RNN, LSTMs, Transformer architectures
Machine Learning Frameworks: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras
Tools and Pipelines: Data preprocessing, normalization, statistical analysis and visualization. (DESeq2, Limma, FastQC, Seaborn, Matplotlib)
Sequencing Technologies: RNA-seq, scRNA-seq, scATAC-seq
Spatial Transcriptomics: Visium 10x, NanoString GeoMx
Website Development: CSS, JavaScript, Node.js, HTML

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Italian: Native Speaker **English**: C1 **Dutch**: A1